

BEYOND THE SCORE

Case 1 · Letoa-Haumata Family

Samoan-Māori intergenerational household, Ōtāhuhu: a managed-retreat letter and a predictive loan offer arrive in the same week, and the second knew before the first.

THE HOUSEHOLD

Teuila-Rose (Teu) Letoa-Haumata 19 · design student, the one the system addressed

“They know too much. But then I think, maybe they can help. But like... help how? For who?”

Teuila-Rose is a first-year design student at AUT, living with her mother and grandmother in a rented house prone to flooding near the Ōtāhuhu estuary. Her cultural world is hybrid: Sunday to’ona’i (shared feast) and tangi (funeral rites) with her Samoan family, kapa haka and wānanga through her Māori side. She has been the family tech troubleshooter since she was twelve — MyMSD, rent portals, school apps all run through her. Financially cautious and protective of her mother, she opted into an open banking pilot partly to help with the bills and partly out of curiosity. When a predictive credit offer arrived, built from that consent, she experienced it as recognition and surveillance at once.

Maria Letoa-Haumata 45 · mother, carer, community liaison

“If the bank starts knowing things we didn’t tell them... what else will they take?”

Maria is the emotional anchor of the household: carework, part-time employment, community roles, and the bills. A long-time South Auckland resident in a rented Kāinga Ora home, she was raised not to owe anything to anyone and still pays bills at the post office when she can. She relies on her daughter for the digital paperwork and holds low trust in banks from years of overdrafts and limited credit. She has moved house for redevelopment before; the letter on the table reads to her as the same pattern with new language.

Asofa Letoa-Haumata 71 · matriarch, Sunday school teacher

“First we came for work. Now they say we must go because the sea is coming. But we did not put the sea there.”

Asofa was born in Samoa and came to Aotearoa in the late 1970s, meeting her Māori husband through church fellowship in Onehunga. Widowed now, she holds the family’s stories, genealogy, and quiet worries in two languages. Her world is tactile and prayerful; she does not use a smartphone, and anything involving money, housing, or health she wants face to face. She planted lemon trees at this house. They are still growing.

THE SCENE

SIMULATION 1 · “What’s Ours to Keep?”

A Friday evening in Ōtāhuhu; rain taps steadily on the roof. Maria has just opened a letter from Kāinga Ora: the rental is now officially classified high-risk for flooding, and a managed-retreat process is coming. Earlier that day, Teuila-Rose’s banking app

pushed a pre-approved predictive loan generated from open banking data she consented to a few weeks earlier. Three generations gather at the kitchen table.

MARIA (*reads from the letter, then sighs*) "They'll 'support us through the transition.'" What transition? We've lived here twelve years. Asofa was baptised down the road.

TEUILA-ROSE (*softly*) It says they'll help with finding a new place. And moving costs. It's not like they're kicking us out tomorrow.

MARIA They don't need to say it. It's already happening. First it was the black mould. Then the water in the garage. Now the whole suburb's 'unfit'? We're not mana-less. We're just... renters.

ASOFA (*watching quietly, then speaking*) When we came from Samoa, I thought we'd finally stop moving. Your father said this land would hold us. Even in a rental. Even with no deed. I planted lemon trees. Still growing. So what do we leave behind now?

TEUILA-ROSE I got this offer today — from the bank. It just popped up. "Based on your spending profile and rental history, you qualify for a \$5,000 home transition loan." Like... they knew. Before we even got the letter.

MARIA (*excited, then wary*) Wait, the bank knew before Kāinga Ora did? How?

TEUILA-ROSE I opted into that open banking thing — remember I told you? It pulls info from our power bill and rent payments. I thought it might help with my budgeting. And I wanted to help you, too.

MARIA (*sits back, rubbing her forehead*) You mean they're watching what we spend? All the time?

TEUILA-ROSE Not like that. It's meant to give better advice. Predict needs. I thought it was smart. But now I feel... exposed.

ASOFA (*in Samoan, gently*) "E sili le vaai i le tagata, nai lo le faitau i lona tala." / It is better to see the person than to read their story on paper.

MARIA Your Nana's right. You're more than a pattern. What if the system misreads us? Says we're high risk? What if next time, it's a mortgage we don't get — not just a loan we didn't ask for?

TEUILA-ROSE I wanted to be ahead. Be smart. They said it was about empowerment.

MARIA Empowerment is knowing when to say no. Not signing everything just because the app has pretty colours and easy buttons.

ASOFA (*speaks slowly, looking at the ceiling*) I've seen the water rise. Not just this year. Many years. But I never thought they would come and take us again. Not with paper. Not with kindness that has no face.

MARIA (*staring at the letter again*) We've moved before. Packed the kitchen. Held the walls one last time. But this time... I feel like the land's moving, not us.

TEUILA-ROSE Maybe we move — and make new roots. Somewhere better. Maybe we learn how to make these systems work for us.

ASOFA We carry land inside us. But don't forget — the system carries memory too. It remembers things we didn't say.

MARIA (*quietly*) Maybe we say it now. Not to them. To each other.

[Scene ends. The rain continues. Teuila-Rose closes her banking app. Asofa reaches for her rosary. Maria folds the letter, slowly and carefully, like it is something sacred or dangerous — or both.]

WHAT MOVED

Two systems arrived in one evening — a retreat letter and a pre-approved loan built from consented data — and the household heard them as one voice. Teuila-Rose's consent, given to help, had made the family legible without their knowing. The app was closed and the letter folded; nothing was decided except to say it to each other first.

ABOUT THIS CASE

The people and events in this case are corpus-constrained composites: relational models built from documented Aotearoa New Zealand research, not portraits of any household, whānau, kāiāiga or community. The arc is an anticipatory scenario — a structured hypothesis built to be tested, not a record of events.

Full case position, design-shift record, and corpus anchors: BTS_Case1_Trace.